UNITED STATES
NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION
REGION IV
1600 EAST LAMAR BOULEVARD
ARLINGTON, TEXAS 76011-4511

March 11, 2026

Julie Statler, Radiation Safety Officer
Grubbs, Hoskyn, Barton & Wyatt, Inc.
P.O. Box 30970
Little Rock, AR 72260

SUBJECT: GRUBBS, HOSKYN, BARTON & WYATT, INC – NRC INSPECTION REPORT 030-12413/2024-001; AND NOTICE OF VIOLATION

Dear Julie Statler:

This letter refers to the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission's (NRC) in-office review of the transfer of control that was submitted to the NRC Region IV office by Grubbs, Hoskyn, Barton & Wyatt, Inc., (GHBW). The in-office inspection was an examination of activities conducted under the GHBW license, to confirm compliance with the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission's (NRC's) rules, regulations, and with the conditions of your license. The inspection consisted of a review of records and correspondence related to the transfer of control. A final exit briefing was conducted via video with you on February 25, 2026.

Our review determined that by letter dated July 12, 2023 (Agencywide Documents Access and Management System [ADAMS] Accession Number ML23205A159), and supplemented with a response on letter dated January 4, 2024, which is not publicly available because it contains security-related information, GHBW submitted a request for a name change to the NRC Region IV office. Upon further review, the license reviewer determined that the name change resulted from an indirect transfer of control of the GHBW NRC license No. 03-17243-01. In correspondence dated October 9, 2023, the NRC was informed that Universal Engineering Sciences, LLC (UES) acquired GHBW. The transfer of control occurred on April 5, 2023, and the amendment request for a name change is dated July 12, 2023.

GHBW submitted a revised change of control request to the NRC Region IV office in letter dated September 18, 2024 (ADAMS Accession No. ML24263A224). The letter confirmed that the transfer of control was finalized on April 5, 2023, and clarified that the acquisition involved Obsidian Group Acquisitions, Inc. (Obsidian), and GHBW. The original letter indicated UES as the owner; however, Obsidian is the sole legal owner of GHBW. Obsidian is a holding company doing business under the trade name "UES." After further discussion, the NRC concluded that Obsidian has acquired and currently owns several engineering firms across the United States, each holding NRC and Agreement State licenses.

Based on the information provided to the NRC in letter dated January 4, 2024, and email September 18, 2024, the NRC has determined that one Severity Level IV violation of NRC requirements occurred. The violation was evaluated in accordance with the NRC Enforcement Policy. The current Enforcement Policy is included on the NRC's Web site at (http://www.nrc.gov/about-nrc/regulatory/enforcement/enforce-pol.html).

The violation involved the failure to obtain written consent from the Commission prior to completing a transfer of control. The violation is being cited in the Notice because it was identified by NRC.

The NRC has concluded that information regarding: (1) the reason for the violation; (2) the corrective actions that have been taken and the results achieved; and (3) the date when full compliance was achieved is already adequately addressed on the docket as described in your letter submitted to the NRC on February 12, 2026. Furthermore, on January 26, 2026, you submitted a request to terminate your license. However, NRC license No. 03-17243-01 was terminated on December 4, 2025, in Amendment No. 15, since a license renewal application was not submitted before the license expired on November 30, 2025. Therefore, you are not required to respond to this letter unless the description herein does not accurately reflect your corrective actions or your position. In that case, or if you choose to provide additional information, you should follow the instructions specified in the enclosed Notice.

In accordance with 10 CFR 2.390 of the NRC's "Agency Rules of Practice and Procedure," a copy of this letter, its enclosure, and your response, if you choose to provide one, will be made available electronically for public inspection in the NRC Public Document Room or from the NRC's Agencywide Documents Access and Management System (ADAMS), accessible from the NRC Web site at http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/adams.html. To the extent possible, your response should not include any personal privacy or proprietary, information so that it can be made available to the Public without redaction.

If you have any questions regarding this in-office review, please feel free to contact Alexus Willis at (817) 200-1187 or Alexus.Willis@nrc.gov.

Sincerely,

Signed by Torres, Roberto
on 03/11/26

Roberto J. Torres, Acting Chief
Materials Licensing Branch
Division of Radiological Safety and Security

Docket No. 030-12413
License No. 03-17243-01
Control No. 643230

Enclosure: Notice of Violation

GRUBBS, HOSKYN, BARTON & WYATT, INC – NRC INSPECTION REPORT 030-12413/2024-001; AND NOTICE OF VIOLATION – DATED MARCH 11, 2026

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ADAMS ACCESSION NUMBER: **ML26069A380**
PACKAGE NUMBER **ML26069A382**
E-CONCURRENCE CASE: **20260310-30016**

NOTICE OF VIOLATION

Grubbs, Hoskyn, Barton & Wyatt, Inc.
Little Rock, Arkansas

License No. 03-17243-01
Docket No. 030-12413

During an NRC in-office review conducted during July 12, 2023, through November 19, 2024, a violation of NRC requirements was identified. In accordance with the NRC Enforcement Policy, the violation is listed below:

> 10 CFR 30.34(b) requires, in part, that no license issued or granted pursuant to the regulations shall be transferred, assigned, or in any manner disposed of, either voluntarily or involuntarily, directly or indirectly, through transfer of control of any license to any person, unless the Commission shall, after securing full information, find that the transfer is in accordance with the provisions of the Act and shall give its consent in writing.
>
> Contrary to the above, on April 5, 2023, the licensee completed a transfer of control of NRC license number 03-17243-01, without receiving the Commission's consent in writing. Specifically, NRC licensee Grubbs, Hoskyn, Barton & Wyatt, Inc., and Obsidian Group Acquisitions, Inc., completed a transfer of control in which Obsidian Group Acquisitions, Inc. acquired ownership of Grubbs, Hoskyn, Barton & Wyatt, Inc., which constituted a change of control under 10 CFR 30.34(b), without receiving prior NRC approval and consent in writing.

This is a Severity Level IV violation (NRC Enforcement Policy Section 6.3.d.7).

The NRC has concluded that information regarding the reason for the violation, the corrective actions taken and planned to correct the issues and prevent recurrence, and the date when full compliance was achieved, is already adequately addressed on the docket in licensee letter dated February 12, 2026. However, if the description therein does not accurately reflect your corrective actions or your position, you are required to submit a written statement or explanation pursuant to 10 CFR 2.201 within 30 days of the date of the letter transmitting this Notice of Violation. In that case, or if you choose to respond, clearly mark your response as a "Reply to a Notice of Violation, NRC Inspection Report 030-12413/2024-001", and send it by email to RobertoJ.Torres@nrc.gov or send hard copies by mail to: U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission; ATTN: Document Control Desk; Washington, DC 20555-0001, with identical copy to: Director, Division of Radiological Safety and Security, U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission Region IV, 1600 E. Lamar Blvd., Arlington, Texas 76011.

Your response, if you choose to provide one, will be made available electronically for public inspection in the NRC Public Document Room or in the NRC's Agencywide Documents Access and Management System (ADAMS), accessible from the NRC website at http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/adams.html. Therefore, to the extent possible, the response should not include any personal privacy or proprietary information so that it can be made available to the public without redaction. If personal privacy or proprietary information is necessary to provide an acceptable response, then please provide a bracketed copy of your response that identifies the information that should be protected and a redacted copy of your response that deletes such information.

If you request withholding of such material, you must specifically identify the portions of your response that you seek to have withheld and provide in detail the bases for your claim of withholding (e.g., explain why the disclosure of information will create an unwarranted invasion of personal privacy or provide the information required by 10 CFR 2.390(b) to support a request for withholding confidential commercial or financial information).

If you contest this enforcement action, you should also provide a copy of your response, with the basis for your denial, to the Director, Office of Enforcement, United States Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001.

In accordance with 10 CFR 19.11, you may be required to post this Notice within 2 working days of receipt.

Dated this 11th day of March 2026